Aicheng (Toby) Tang

Portfolio: https://zshoh131499.github.io/my-portfolio/

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EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY - *M.P. S Information Science*
GPA: 4.13 **AUG 2025 ONGOING**

- **Relevant Coursework**: Designing Technology for Social Impact, HCI Design, Crowdsourcing and Human Computation, Computing for Information Science , AI Chatbots RAG and AI Agents, AI Innovation Lab

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY - *B.S. Games and Simulations Arts and Sciences / B.S. Electronic Arts*
GPA: 3.54 **AUG 2021 - DEC 2024**

- **Relevant Coursework**: Game Animation, Interactive Media Design, 3D Visual Effect, 3D Technical Direction, 3D Digital Modeling, 2D Experimental Animation, Game Design, Experimental Game Design, Game Programming, 3D Modeling with Blender

EXPERIENCE

Assurant (Intern), Atlanta, GA - *UX Researcher / Conversational Design* **JAN 2026 - NOW**

- Researched how **GenAI** could be integrated into **enterprise IVR experiences**, with a focus on disclosure, flow design, and handoffs between **IVR, AI**, and live agents
- Helped shape **prompt strategy**, **persona direction**, **voice continuity**, **fallback behavior**, and **transition logic** for auto-service journeys
- Supported **prototype flows**, **research synthesis**, and **user testing plans** centered on confidence, clarity, and containment
- Turned **research findings** into practical recommendations and **design guidance** for stakeholders

Ecolab (Contract), St. Paul, MN - *Data Science / ML Researcher* **SEP 2025 - DEC 2025**

- Developing a **data quality and analytics pipeline** to standardize large time-series datasets, produce **model-ready daily aggregate**.
- Applying **EDA and visualization** to surface high-value signals and guide downstream **feature engineering and modeling**.
- **Improved operational performance** by incorporating domain/physical constraints; **achieved 100% accuracy** on no-corrosion cases **and 74% detection** on corrosion cases in the best XGBoost configuration.
- Built **EDA dashboards** to diagnose uneven sensor uptime and multi-day outages, and turned those findings into **data-quality filters** for training/evaluation.

Mechanist Games (Intern), Xiamen, China - *VFX Artist* **FEB 2025 – MAY 2025**

- Created real-time visual effects in Unity, including UI effects, character effects, and illustration-based special effects for live projects
- Collaborated closely with **designers** and **programmers** to align gameplay mechanics with visual impact and ensure smooth in-engine implementation
- Worked alongside other **VFX artists** to maintain stylistic consistency and share technical solutions
- Gained hands-on experience with **asset optimization and resource management**, improving game performance and project organization

Sharron Art Center (Part Time), North Brunswick, NJ - *Instructor* **JUN 2023 - AUG 2024**

- **2 Term** Summer Class (June-August 2023/ June-August 2024) Served as the **sole instructor** for the "Intro to Game Design" course, specializing in **concept art design, character art design, and environmental art design**.
- **30 classes** (**3 hours long class time**) taught skills in character art design, covering principles of character design, expressions.
- **Designed and implemented courses with a focus on fostering students'** creative expression, they ended up making **their individual portfolio**
- Covering **art fundamentals, game art pipeline, and animation**

Private Portfolio Instructor(Self Employed), Warren, NJ - *Instructor* **DEC 2022 - FEB 2023**

- Developed **personalized lesson plans for each student**, ensuring that the curriculum catered to their specific artistic goals and skill levels
- Assisted students in curating and **organizing their portfolios, coherence for college admissions** and exhibitions

EXHIBITION

Collar Works, Troy, NY - *Artist* **MAR 2024 - APR 2024**

- Combined **traditional Chinese calligraphy with 3D animation**, using **Blender and Houdini** to create ink painting shader and textures. Background wall covered with my calligraphy, offering viewers a new **visual experience bridging traditional and digital art**

PROJECTS

Freestyle Exile - *Artist / Game Designer* **JAN 2023 - MAY2023**

- **Lead concept 2D artist and 3D artist for the game's development**
- **Design concept art for** environment, prop, and character**, hard-surface modeled** environment props
- Created **initial textures for the protagonist** and **enemy unit materials, worked with another 3D artist** with UV unwrap and texturing
- Designed **posters and in-game decals** to enhance the game world's atmosphere

Dream Raiders 2 — *VFX Artist (UI & Gameplay) | Mechanist Games* **FEB 2025 - MAY 2025**

- Built **real-time UI VFX in Unity** (HUD cues, damage/heal feedback, menu & combat prompts) to **improve gameplay readability**.
- Designed and implemented **character skill VFX** (charge-ups, projectiles, impacts, status effects) using **Particle System / VFX Graph** and **Shader Graph**.
- Created **champion & monster VFX** with **texture atlasing** to meet performance budgets.

SKILLS

Creative: **Unity, Blender, Maya, Houdini, Figma, After Effects, Photoshop, Python, C#,** 3DS MAX, Illustrator, Premiere
Production: **Perforce, Github, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Suite**

AWARDS

Freestyle Exile won Excellence in Design Award at RPI's GameFest 23 MAY 2023
Dean's Honor List FEB 2022 - DEC 2024